CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 21

Ainsley Duskwood

FORTUNE-BOOTH PERFORMER (STAGE ACT ONLY)



"You read fortunes for fun. Tonight nobody laughed."

FOR AINSLEY DUSKWOOD'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 12+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A black cloak or shawl dotted with paper stars, lots of bangles and a scarf tied around your head.

Mask: a silver star mask cut from foil-covered card.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

> **If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.** You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

Vesper called your fortune booth “nonsense” and said it would not be part of the museum.

YOUR SECRET

Your fortune act is pure guesswork, helped by gossip you hear in the queue. Tonight you told everyone in your queue, “A door will close on someone at nine,” because you had overheard gossip about Vesper’s announcement.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:15 to 8:50 you sat in the conservatory with your queue of fortune-seekers. Your black cloak never left the booth.

YOUR GOALS

- Prove your black cloak never left the conservatory.
- Keep your “gift” a secret until Round 2.
- Make one dramatic prediction that comes true.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You read fortunes in the conservatory from 8:15 to 8:50 with a queue the whole time. You wear a black cloak, yes, but it never left your booth. All evening you told your queue, "A door will close on someone at nine."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Do you believe in fortunes, and what did Vesper's last one say?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "How many black cloaks did you make this year?"

YOUR TASK

> "Read the palm" of one suspect and predict where they were at 8:35.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess your secret: the fortunes are guesswork and gossip. Your "door will close at nine" came from queue chatter about Vesper's announcement. Everyone knew something big was coming at nine.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Do you print fortunes in the Gazette?"

? Ask **Corin Thimble:** "What did you see from the balcony?"

YOUR TASK

> Find one person who believes in the Lantern Ghost and one who doesn't.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Say that face paint tells a story too: gold paint rubs onto anything you press against your face. Then make your big prediction: "The truth is downstairs."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you ever paint your face this year?"

? Ask **Teagan Bramwell:** "Who uses the Back Stairs most?"

YOUR TASK

> Write your prediction on your ballot and see if it comes true.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade